1 *History* (Vol. I), p. 38.

2 The question whether the RBI should be a government owned bank or a bank owned by private shareholders was the subject of animated debate. The unfortunate experience of countries with State-controlled banks during and after the First World War had led to a trend in many countries of setting up, or reconstituting, central banks with private capital so as to prevent political interference in their day-to-day management. To ensure that national interest was not compromised, the government was vested with sufficient powers for intervention in the bank's policies. The intention was to enjoy the best of both worlds, i.e. to prevent government interference while retaining adequate control. The Reserve Bank of India Act had built-in-checks and counter-checks and this arrangement allayed the fears of members of the Legislature, who were of the opinion that a few big entrenched industrialists would manipulate policies to suit their own interests.

3 *History* (Vol. I), p. 88.

4 A. Ramaswami Mudaliar wanted that this should also be extended to the Governor and the Deputy Governors. But this was eventually dropped when practical difficulties associated with such powers were explained. The Board could dispense with the Governor by an ordinary majority but could make it impossible for the Governor General to remove a Governor they wanted to retain.

5 C.D. Deshmukh, 'Central Banking in India: A Retrospect', pp. 19–20.

6 G. Balachandran, *John Bullion's Empire*, Curzon Press, Surrey, 1996, p. 210.

7 *Ibid.*, p. 209.

8 *Ibid.*, p. 210.

9 Aditya Mukherjee *Op. Cit.*, p. 125.

10 G. Balachandran, 'Towards a Hindoo Marriage', p. 635.

11 *Ibid.*, p. 638.

12 Aditya Mukherjee, *Op. Cit.*, p. 130.

13 G. Balachandran, 'Towards a Hindoo Marriage' p. 637.

14 G. Balachandran, *John Bullion's Empire*, Curzon Press, Surrey, 1996,